



Republic of Ireland

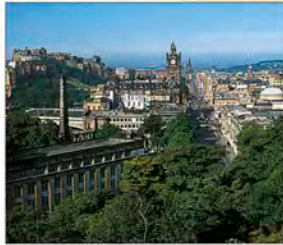


United Kingdom



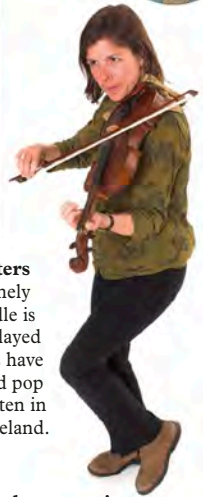
Arty Edinburgh

For three weeks every August, a big arts festival takes place in Edinburgh, the historic capital of Scotland. The fringe festival gives amateur and part-time entertainers the chance to perform, and also attracts some of the world's best musicians, theater companies, and artists.



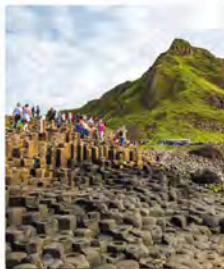
Music masters

Traditional folk music is extremely popular in Ireland. The fiddle is a typical folk instrument, often played to accompany singers. Irish bands have been very successful on the world pop scene. Many songs were first written in Gaelic, the original language of Ireland.



A divided community

Northern Ireland is part of the United Kingdom but remains politically divided, mostly along religious lines. Unionists (mostly Protestants) consider themselves British and want to stay part of the United Kingdom, whereas Republicans (mostly Catholics) see themselves as Irish, and want to be part of a united Ireland.



Possible new laws are debated in the Lords' Chamber.

National pride

The Welsh are proud of their culture, and enjoy celebrating national festivals. St. David is the patron saint of Wales, so on St. David's Day, children go to school wearing traditional Welsh costumes.

The daffodil is the national flower of Wales.

